

Interview Ready: Student Handout

LSC 1503 Professional Spoken Communication · Interview Assessment (20%, Week 8) Name: _____

1. The interview at a glance

Just you

Individual interview with your teacher.
Sometimes a third person is in the room.

In person

Face to face, not online.

3–5 minutes

Short, so every answer counts.

Recorded

Audio on BB Collaborate. Other teachers listen too.

Questions you will get

- **Q1 (always):** Tell me about yourself.
- **Q2 (always):** Which study skill from LSC 1503 might be most useful in your future job? Give an example.
- **1-2 teacher's choice** from 3a–3h (you won't know which).
- **Follow-ups** to help you say more.

Follow-up questions to expect

Can you tell me more about that?

Can you give me an example of that?

What did you do in that situation?

Could you repeat that?

Could you say that in a different way?

No notes. No phone, no papers, no reading from a screen. Prepare, then speak naturally.

2. How you are marked (the rubric in plain English)

Content 40

Prof. 10

Language 25

Communication 25

Content · 40

- Answer the question you hear
- True examples with details
- Sound natural, not memorized
- Listen actively

Professionalism · 10

- On time
- National dress, formal clothes or uniform
- Polite: good morning / thank you

Language · 25

- Course vocabulary & grammar
- Keep talking (fluency)
- Fix small mistakes calmly

Communication · 25

- Clear, loud voice; pauses
- Eye contact, posture, gestures
- Confidence strategies; no notes

Depth wins marks: Say it → Show it → So what? "I'm organized." → "I made a plan with a deadline for each person." → "We finished two days early." Give one real example in every answer.

Professionalism and body language

Treat it like a real interview from start to finish

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3. From the door to "thank you"

Before

- Prepare clothes the night before
- Arrive 5-10 minutes early
- Phone off and away; few bags
- Stand tall, breathe in 4 / out 6

At the door & during

Knock and wait.

Good morning, Ms _____. May I come in?

Thank you.

I'm very well, thank you. How are you?

Listen, answer the real question, stay positive.

At the end

Thank you for your time. Have a nice day.

Stand up calmly, smile, leave quietly.

4. Body language and voice

✓ Do

- Sit up straight, lean slightly forward
- Eye contact with the interviewer
- Open-palm gestures, hands relaxed
- Smile when you greet and leave
- Speak loudly enough for the recording

✗ Don't

- Cross your arms or slouch
- Look at the floor or the window
- Play with a pen, keys or your sleeve
- Speak too fast or too quietly

Greeting

Follow the interviewer's lead. A smile, a small nod and a hand on the heart is polite and professional. Don't reach for a handshake unless it is offered.

5. Confidence toolkit

Buy time politely

That's a good question.

Let me think for a moment. Well, let me see...

You didn't understand

Sorry, could you repeat the question, please?

Do you mean...?

Could you say that in a different way?

Fix a mistake · turn a hesitation into a pause

Feel an "umm" coming? Close your mouth, breathe, continue.

Sorry, I mean... Let me say that again.

Once or twice will not affect your grade. Then keep going.

Extend your answer

For example,... For instance,... because...

so... That experience taught me...

5. The questions and their maps

Plan every answer in 4 steps. Aim for 45–90 seconds per answer.

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Q1 Tell me about yourself.

1. Present 2. Past 3. Personal 4. Future

My name is... I'm currently studying... Before HCT, I... That experience taught me...

I would describe myself as... For example,... In the future, I would like to... because...

Q2 Which study skill might be most useful for your future job? Give an example.

1. Skill + job 2. What I learned 3. Why my job needs it 4. Example at work

I think ... might be the most useful for my future job as a... In this module, I learned how to...

...need to... because... For example, if..., I would...

The 12 study skills: Memory & Concentration · Note-taking · Time Management · Your Healthy Lifestyle · Accessing & Analyzing Information · Agility & Adaptability · Collaboration vs Plagiarism · Critical Thinking · Effective Communication · Exam Preparation · Learning Styles · Good Homework Habits

3a What are your strengths and weaknesses?

1. Strength 2. Example 3. Weakness 4. Improvement

One of my strengths is that I'm... For example, when I... One thing I'm working on is...

To improve, I'm... I have already...

Choose a **real, small** weakness you are improving. Never "I have no weaknesses", "I'm always late" or "I'm too perfect".

3b Do you like working independently or in teams? Why / Why not?

1. My choice 2. Reason 3. Example 4. Balance

I prefer working... because... For example, when I... However, I can also...

No wrong choice. Never blame other people.

3c 3d 3e "Tell me about a time when..." → tell a true story with STAR

S. Situation T. Task A. Action (biggest part — say "I") R. Result + lesson

- **3c Teamwork:** also say what was **challenging** and what you **enjoyed**.
- **3d Explaining:** also say **how you checked** they understood (ask them to explain it back or show you).
- **3e Challenge / conflict:** stay calm, be positive, end with what you learned.

Last semester, in my... My job was to... First, I... Then I... In the end,... I learned that...

3f 3g 3h Future questions: college → career

- **3f College and work:** Skill I'm building → Where I learned it → Example → How it helps at work.
- **3g What I like:** What I like → Why → Example → Link to my future.
- **3h After college:** My goal → Why → My plan → What I can offer.

HCT is helping me to... What I enjoy most is... After college, I would like to work as...

I'm planning to... Later, I hope to...

Be **specific**: name a class, a place, a job, a number.

Key words and grammar

Language that shows the teacher your course vocabulary

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6. Key words

punctual	ملتزم بالمواعيد
polite	مُهدَّب
active listening	الإصغاء الفعّال
eye contact	التواصل البصري
posture	وضعية الجسم
gesture	إيماءة (حركة اليد)
self-correct	يُصحّ نفسه
follow-up question	سؤال متابعة
currently	حاليًا
graduate (from)	يتخرّج (من)
experience	خبرة / تجربة
strategy	استراتيجية / طريقة
prioritize	يُحدّد الأولويات
deadline	موعد نهائي
reliable source	مصدر موثوق
plagiarism	الانتحال
organized	منظّم
improve	يُحسّن / يتحسّن
independently	بشكل مستقل
challenge	تحدّي
conflict	خلاف / نزاع
deal with	يتعامل مع
compromise	حلّ وسط
career	مسيرة مهنية
work placement	تدريب عملي في جهة عمل
contribute to	يُساهم في

7. Grammar you will need

Now & habits

I'm currently studying... *HCT is helping me to...*
I enjoy working in teams.

Past stories

I graduated in 2025. *While we were preparing,...*
First, I... Then I... In the end,...

Until now

I have always been interested in...
I have become more confident.

Future & imagined situations

I would like to... / I'm planning to... / I hope to...
If a customer calls, I would...

Also revise your **LSC 1503 Key Language List (Unit 2)**, your **Grammar Self-Study 1 and 2**, and your Nearpod. The rubric rewards course language.

8. Your preparation plan

Tick each step as you finish it

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Step by step

- ☐ Read this handout and the assessment instructions
- ☐ Work through the Interview Ready apps
- ☐ Write my script for all 10 questions
- ☐ Underline 5-8 **keywords** in each answer
- ☐ Practise from the keywords, not the script
- ☐ Record myself and listen back
- ☐ Do a full mock interview with a partner
- ☐ Ask my partner for one star ★ and one wish 🌱
- ☐ Check my clothes and plan to arrive early

Interview day checklist

- ☐ Professional clothing (national dress / formal / uniform)
- ☐ Arrive 5-10 minutes early
- ☐ Phone off and away; no extra bags
- ☐ Two slow breaths before I knock
- ☐ Greet, thank, smile, sit up straight
- ☐ Listen carefully and answer the real question
- ☐ Give one real example in every answer
- ☐ Thank the interviewer at the end

Golden rule: prepared, but not memorized.

9. My answers in keywords

Q1 Tell me about yourself

Q2 Study skill for my future job

My teacher's choice question (1)

My teacher's choice question (2)

10. The Interview Ready apps

1. Step Into the Room

The exam, the rubric, professionalism, body language

2. Tell Me About Yourself

Question 1

3. Study Skills for My Future Job

Question 2

4. Self-Description

Questions 3a, 3b

5. Behavioural

Questions 3c, 3d, 3e

6. Future Questions

Questions 3f, 3g, 3h

7. The Mock Interview

All questions, peer practice, my script

My links / notes